SEYCHELLES SPORTS FISHING CLUB

15th Annual Marlin Slam Fishing Tournament Sponsored by Heineken

25th April 2026

RULES & REGISTRATION FORM

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1. **STYLE** - This is a trolling jigging and popping competition and fish must be caught on rod & reel only using live bait, dead bait or artificial lures. Electric reels are not allowed except for use with hookless teasers. Hand lines will be allowed for running hookless teasers only.

2. **ANGLERS** - A team must consist of a minimum of 2 anglers.

3. **STARTING TIME** - Departure time is 2:00 A.M. on Saturday, 25th April 2026 from Eden Island Marina, Praslin, La Digue, the Wharf Hotel Marina, Providence and Marine Charter only.

4. **ENDING TIME** - Return time to Eden Island Marina is 5:00 P.M. on Saturday, 25th April 2026.

5. **SKIPPERS' MEETING** - A skippers/team meeting will be held at Eden Island Boardwalk from 5pm to 6pm on Wednesday 22nd April 2026. All teams must be represented by at least 1 team member. All registration fees must be paid at the time of registration. Credit will not be accepted.

6. **REGISTRATION DEADLINE** - The deadline for registration is 6:00 P.M on Friday, 24th April 2026.

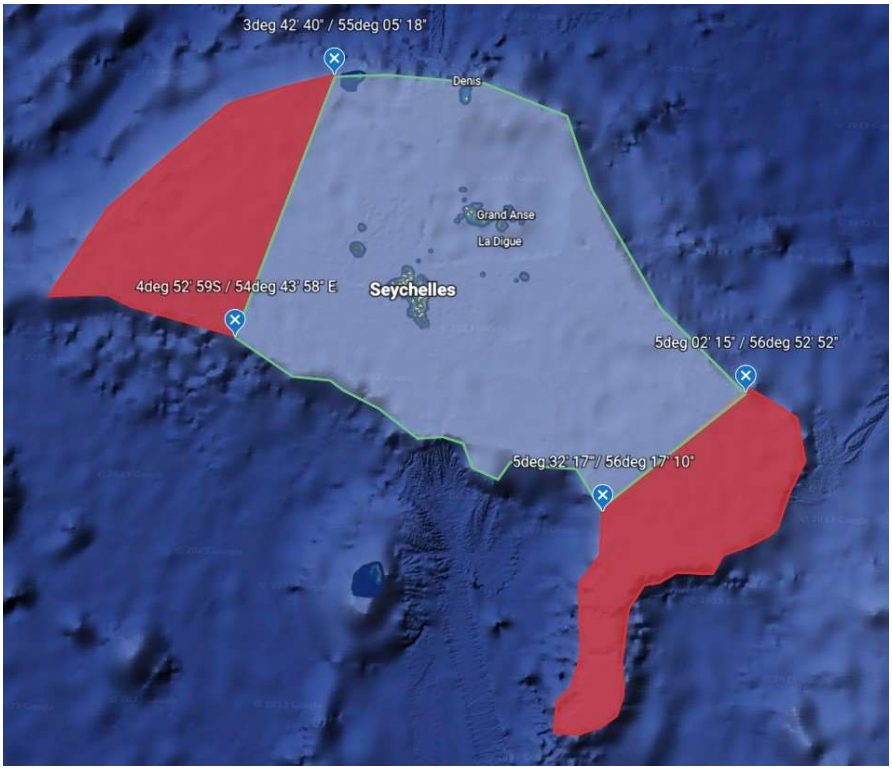
7. **REGISTRATION FEE** - The entrance fee is SR 5,000. No refund will be issued once a team has registered. However, a team may switch to another boat prior to the registration deadline.

8. **PRIZE GIVING** - The prize-giving will be held at Eden Island Marina immediately after the weigh-in once the results have been calculated on Saturday, 25th April 2026.

9. **INSPECTION OF BOATS** - A member of the Tournament Committee/Officials has the right to board any boat for inspection prior to departure. The boat will be automatically disqualified if fish other than bait is found onboard. The organising committee reserves the right to board any boat at weigh-in and inspect the equipment used. Team members may be asked to submit written accounts of the catch or submit to questioning by the Weighmaster. Failure to allow an inspection to be carried out or a refusal to answer questions will result in automatic disqualification.

10. **EMERGENCY INFORMATION** – For security purposes, each team must leave a sealed envelope with the Tournament Officials at the Skippers' meeting on Wednesday, 22nd April 2026. The Team must state the general area where the boat plans to fish during the competition. This information will only be used in the event of an emergency. In the event of an emergency, engine failure or where a vessel has requested assistance to be towed back to Mahe, we encourage all boats in the vicinity to respond immediately. Note that any boat providing such assistance to a distressed vessel will not be penalized for arriving past the competition deadline and the boat will be eligible for weigh-in and prizes.

11. **DESIGNATED FISHING GRID**: All teams are required to fish within the following grid +10 nm off the dropoff and shall not enter the red zones on the grid.



12. **ICE** - Please make your own arrangements for ice.

13. **IGFA RULES** -IGFA equipment rules apply to all. IGFA angling rules apply to all except in the following circumstances:

    a. Once a fish is hooked, the rod can be passed to only 1 angler. Once the rod is passed to the angler, it cannot be transferred to another angler.

    b. IGFA equipment rules apply but IGFA angling rules do not apply to ladies and juniors.

    c. For team members with a computer and internet access, please log onto www.igfa.org for IGFA rules. Those with no access to a computer should contact Mr. Faizal Suleman on 2511994 (Seychelles IGFA Representative) for a set of printed rules

14. **SPECIAL BILLFISH RULES** - SSFC encourages all teams to tag and release any billfish caught during the tournament. Sailfish/spearfish/swordfish will not be weighed at the weigh station. SSFC also encourages all teams who have already boated a marlin to release any other marlin caught and considered to be of a lesser weight than the boated one;

    a. Release of billfish forms a part of the tournament scoring.

    b. All billfish caught must be filmed on video as evidence in order to be eligible for points;

    c. Under all circumstances, the team must do its utmost to revive a billfish prior to release.

15. **RELEASE RULES & PROCEDURES** - A billfish will be considered as released according to the IGFA rules as well as to Tournament Release Procedures:

    a. A fish is considered officially released when one of the following actions is completed;

    b. The crew is able to grab the leader;

    c. The swivel hits the rod tip;

    d. The connection (knot, splice, etc.) between the leader and the mainline/double passes through the rod tip

    e. Record the catch and release as per the release video camera requirements below.

16. **RELEASE VIDEO CAMERA REQUIREMENTS** - To score an official release, the video footage must include sufficient uninterrupted footage to:

    a. Show a team member or crew with the leader in hand while the fish is still hooked;

    b. Show GPS time after the fish is released;

    c. Clearly identify the species.

    d. Only the team captain will be allowed in the video review area.

    e. At the end of the day's fishing, the video camera, its connection devices and all video footage must be brought to the weigh station for verification of official release or boated points.

    f. Final review and acceptance of video footage is the responsibility of the SSFC tournament organizers and weigh-master/judge.

17. **UNACCEPTABLE FISH** - Mutilated fish will not be eligible to be weighed.

18. PENALTY - A boat will be disqualified prior to the start of the tournament if it does not have a representative at the Skipper's Meeting.

a. A boat will be disqualified if it arrives outside the area below after the

deadline of GPS Time 5:00PM, Saturday, 25th April 2026;

b. A boat will be disqualified if during the tournament, it receives fuel from another vessel or refuels from a source other than regular fuel depots on Mahe;

c. A boat must catch, store and return to the weighing station with fish caught by the team members on that boat only, and during the tournament only. A boat will be disqualified if it weighs in fish from any other source, or if it weighs fish caught prior to the start of the tournament;

d. A boat will be disqualified if a non-registered person other than pre-approved members of the media joins the boat or is discovered on the boat during the tournament;

e. A boat will be disqualified if a team member joins the boat after the tournament has started. Note that all members of a team must be onboard when the boat departs and the same team members must be onboard when the boat returns to the weigh-in station;

f. A boat will be disqualified if a team member disembarks from the boat during the tournament and then rejoins the boat from a different location;

g. A boat will be disqualified if a team member disembarks from the boat during the tournament. The only exception is when during the tournament, a boat informs the Tournament Organizer that it is offloading a sick or injured team member (or members), or offloading a team member due to an emergency situation. In such cases, the boat will be allowed to continue participating in the tournament without being disqualified;

h. A boat will be disqualified if it catches a billfish with a tassel; use of tassels will result in a ban for life

i. A boat will be disqualified if it does not return to the weigh station under its own power; the assisting boat assisting a distressed/towed boat still remains eligible for prizes

j. A boat that is disqualified will not be eligible for prizes.

k. The use of foul language towards the weigh-in team or rules officials by the team or the team's associates will result in immediate disqualification.

19. **WEIGH-IN** - Weigh-in station shall open at 3:00 P.M. Saturday, 25th April 2026 at Eden Island Marina. Boats must leave the weigh station pontoon as quickly as possible after the weigh-in to make room for others.

20. **WEIGH-IN AREA** - Only the Team whose catch is being currently weighed will be allowed into the designated weighing area. The Team Captain will sign the prescribed form after the weighing is completed and receive a copy signifying his agreement thereto. No results will be issued during the weigh-in process.

21. **FISH** – Helpers will be available to assist with the removal of fish from the boat to the designated weigh-in area. Participants are allowed to keep their catch. Please ensure that fish are not left at the weigh station or in the Marina.

22. **PROTESTS** – Any protests must be lodged by the registered team captain in writing only to Weighmaster 1 hour after the last boat has weighed in. The protest must be accompanied by a deposit of SR 2,500. The Weighmaster will consult with the tournament officials and their decision will be final and only announced at the prize-giving ceremony.

23. **MINIMUM WEIGHT** – Any marlin brought to the weigh station must have a MINIMUM weight of 125 kg. Only 2 marlin will be weighed. The team captain will officially identify to the weighmaster the 2 marlin to be weighed. It is the Team Captain's responsibility to identify the team's heaviest 2 marlin. Any marlin brought to the weigh station that is below 125 kg will receive zero points.

24. **WINNER** - A qualifying marlin means a marlin that complies with the IGFA Rules (Rule 13), the Special Billfish Rules (Rule 14) and the Minimum Weight requirement (Rule 23), and for which the required video evidence has been submitted and accepted by the Tournament Organisers/Weighmaster.

    a. The winning team shall be determined based on the heaviest qualifying marlin. Only 2 marlin will be weighed per boat/team/registered captain. The team captain will officially identify to the weighmaster the 2 marlin to be weighed. It is the Team Captain's responsibility to identify the team's heaviest 2 marlin.

    b. Should no team weigh in a qualifying marlin, the winner shall be determined by total qualifying marlin releases in accordance with

the IGFA Rules (Rule 13), Special Billfish Rules (Rule 14), Release Rules & Procedures (Rule 15), and Release Video Camera Requirements (Rule 16).

c. Should no team weigh in a qualifying marlin and no team record a qualifying marlin release, the winner shall be determined in accordance with Rule 25 (Tournament Ranking).

d. All marlin caught shall be filmed during the catch and at the time of release or gaffing/landing. Any marlin not filmed in accordance with the applicable tournament video requirements, including the Special Billfish Rules (Rule 14) and the Release Video Camera Requirements (Rule 16), will not be eligible for a prize. For any marlin brought to the weigh station, uninterrupted video evidence of the landing must be submitted at the time of weigh-in for verification. The Tournament Organiser reserves the right to use any video for promoting the organisation, sponsor or future tournaments.

25. TOURNAMENT RANKING

a. For tournament ranking purposes, the team with the heaviest qualifying marlin shall be declared the winner, followed by 2nd, 3rd, 4th and so forth for teams that have weighed in a qualifying marlin.

b. In the event that no team weighs in a qualifying marlin, rankings shall be based on the total number of qualifying marlin releases in accordance with the IGFA Rules (Rule 13), Special Billfish Rules (Rule 14), Release Rules & Procedures (Rule 15), and Release Video Camera Requirements (Rule 16). Should there be a tie in the number of qualifying marlin releases, the higher-ranked team shall be determined based on the earliest GPS time recorded on video of the tying marlin release.

c. Should there be a tie in the weight of the heaviest qualifying marlin, the higher-ranked team shall be determined based on the earliest GPS time recorded on video of that marlin.

d. In the event that no team weighs in a qualifying marlin and no team records a qualifying marlin release, the winner shall be determined based on the points accumulated from the following fish:

e. Other billfish (sailfish/swordfish/spearfish) – 150 points awarded for release only in accordance with Rules 13 to 16; unlimited releases allowed; weigh-in not eligible for points
Dorado – weight x 1 point; 2 fish weighed only
Wahoo/Kingfish – weight x 1 point; 2 fish weighed only
Dogtooth Tuna – weight x 1 point; 2 fish weighed only
Yellowfin Tuna – weight x 1 point; 2 fish weighed only

26. PRIZES

a. TOURNAMENT WINNER: The team placed 1st under Rules 24 and 25 will be awarded a cash prize of SCR 125,000.

b. TOURNAMENT RUNNER-UP – MARLIN CAUGHT/RELEASED: The team placed 2nd under Rules 24 and 25 will receive a cash prize of SCR 50,000.

c. TOURNAMENT 3RD PLACE – MARLIN CAUGHT/RELEASED: The team placed 3rd under Rules 24 and 25 will receive a cash prize of SCR 25,000.

d. A team can only win once. For clarity, if a team has the top 2 qualifying marlin, that team may only win Tournament Winner and not both Tournament Winner and Runner-Up. The same principle shall apply to any other method of qualification under Rules 24 and 25.

TOURNAMENT OFFICIALS & ORGANIZERS

Chairman – Grant Heyer

Arthur Fourcroy – Tournament Organizer

Elsa Canaya – Executive Secretary

SSFC Faizal Suleman – IGFA Representative

Fred Payet / Captain Alain Kahn / Captain Houareau - Official Weighmasters/Judges

TEAM NAME	BOAT NAME	REGISTRATION NO.
TEAM CAPTAIN	SAT PHONE NO.	TEL NO.
SKIPPER'S NAME	TEL NO.	TOTAL ON BOARD (Incl. crew)

NO.	OTHER ANGLERS	TEL NO.
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
11		
12		
13		
14		
15		
16		
17		
18		

REGISTRATION FEE SR 5,000 per boat

PRIZE-GIVING Eden Island Marina – Saturday 25th April 2026

We have read and fully understand the rules governing our participation in this competition and agree to abide by them. In the event of a matter arising that is not covered by the rules, we accept that "fair play" shall apply and that the subsequent decision of the tournament officials shall be final.

All boats registered do so at their own risk. By registering as an angler in the tournament, the angler holds harmless the Tournament Committee, Tournament Judges, Organizers, Sponsors and all persons connected directly or indirectly with the operation of the Tournament from any liability for libel, slander, loss, damage, negligence, harm, injury, or death suffered by any participant, entrant, sports fisherman, their companions, boat captains, crew members, family, vessels and equipment which occur during or in conjunction with the Tournament.

TEAM CAPTAIN	TOURNAMENT OFFICIAL
_____	_____

PAYMENT DETAILS

OFFICIAL USE ONLY	CASH	CHEQUE/ DETAILS
DATE:	RECEIPT NO.	SIGNATURE